# LONWABO ZIKHALI

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An emerging Data Scientist with a dual academic foundation in Data Science and Software Engineering, underpinned by strong mathematical and programming skills. Experienced in developing data pipelines, building machine learning models, and deploying full-stack applications. Passionate about analytical problem-solving and contributing to high-performance, collaborative teams.

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| ID: | 2000/09/04 |
| GENDER: | Female |
| NATIONALITY: | South African |
| RACE: | African |
| LANGUAGES: | English, Zulu, Afrikaans, Tswana, Sotho, Xhosa |
| DRIVERS LICENCE: | Code C1 |

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## EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS:

**Master of Science (NQF Level 9) – Data Science (IT),** University of the Witwatersrand, Johannesburg (2026 to date)

**Postgraduate Diploma (NQF Level 8) – Data Science (IT)**, University of the Witwatersrand, Johannesburg (2025)

**BHSc (NQF Level 7) – Biomedical Science**, University of the Witwatersrand, Johannesburg (2020 – 2022)

**Occupational Certificate (NQF Level 6) - Software Engineering (IT)**, WeThinkCode_ Johannesburg (2024 – 2025)

**High School (Grade 12):** Germiston High School, (2014 – 2018)

## CERTIFICATION AND SKILLS:

**Full Stack Development**: FNB App Academy (2025)

**Generative AI for Software Engineers**: WeThinkCode_ (2025)

**Digital Transformation**: University of the Witwatersrand (2024)

**Microsoft PowerBI Data Analyst (PL300T00-A):** Microsoft Elevate

**Microsoft Azure Administrator Associate**

**Rapid Developer**: Mendix Academy (2026)

**End to end Machine Learning**: DataCamp

## EMPLOYMENT:

**UNIVERSITY OF THE WITWATERSRAND (2026):** Academic Tutor - Programming and Mathematical and Statistical Foundations of Data Science

- Mentoring Postgraduate Diploma in Data Science Students
- Course Curation and assisting Lecturers in the Development of Coursework and Exams
- Invigilation and assistance with exam queries
- Assisting lecturers with Course Administration
- Management of Course Content on Learning Management System Moodle

**THE SOUTH AFRICAN BREWERIES (2023):** Reporting and Data Analytics Intern

- Captured, cleaned, and analysed large operational datasets using SQL and Excel to track efficiency and performance.
- Designed, optimized, and maintained SQL queries, data models, and database structures ensuring data integrity and availability.
- Built ETL pipelines and ODBC integrations to support scalable data warehousing and analytics.
- Developed interactive KPI dashboards and reports using Power BI, Power Query, and DAX.
- Automated workflows, reporting, and internal processes using scripting and bots to improve productivity.
- Mapped end-to-end business processes and implemented data-driven optimization initiatives.
- Performed data validation, cleansing, and ad hoc reporting for business units.
- Collaborated with developers and stakeholders on database design, reporting needs, and system improvements.
- Monitored data quality and system performance, documented processes, and supported ongoing analytics and reporting.

## VOLUNTEERING:

**INDEPENDENT ELECTORAL COMMISSION (29-30 May 2024):** Electoral Officer

- Processed and validated data for 500+ voters, ensuring full compliance and accuracy.

- Coordinated logistics, data entry, and crowd management under high-pressure conditions.
- Facilitated voter registration and processing with 100% documentation accuracy.
- Identified and escalated issues early, preventing delays and maintaining order.
- Handled and reconciled materials securely, achieving error-free ballot accounting.

## ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Graduated my Postgraduate Diploma with Distinction.
- Awarded Postgraduate Merit Award Bursary by the University of the Witwatersrand, which is awarded to top performers.

## TOOLS & SKILLS:

**Data Science & Machine Learning**: Scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Apache Spark, Jupyter Notebook, Google Colab, exploratory data analysis, feature engineering, model evaluation, and basic deep learning workflows

**Data Analysis, Visualisation & Reporting**: Power BI, Tableau, Microsoft Excel (Pivot Tables, VLOOKUP, basic macros), T-SQL, DAX, Power BI M language, API integration (REST), data cleaning, reporting automation, and dashboard development, PowerBI M language, DAX

**Databases & Data Engineering**: Relational database design, RDBMS management, SQL querying, data pipelines, data staging, and foundational data warehousing concepts (Kimball methodology)

**Software Engineering & Development Tools**: GitHub, GitLab, ActiveMQ, Docker, Linux, VS Code, IntelliJ, Agile development practices, debugging, and collaborative software development

**Cloud & Infrastructure (Foundational)**: Microsoft Azure, Oracle Cloud, basic DevOps concepts, and networking fundamentals

**Statistical & Analytical Competencies**: Statistical analysis, problem decomposition, algorithmic thinking, object-relational mapping (ORM), and applied data-driven decision-making

## REFEREES:

**Nolundi Mahlwabi**, Colleague – The South African Breweries

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**Dr Sylvester I. Omoruyi**, Supervisor – University of the Witwatersrand School of Anatomical Science

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**Nakitha van Jaarsveld**, Supervisor – WeThinkCode_

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